Volume III: SoM for Data Management: Modeling & Architecture Research

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Version 1.0



August 2026

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Analysis is based on academic research, NASA/ESA technical reports, and industry data as of 2026.
As a commercial entity developing ODC technologies, Zebrid PTE. LTD. discloses a commercial interest in the architectures discussed herein, specifically regarding proprietary storage controllers and ODC module designs.
The authors use AI technologies, under human supervision, in drafting and editing this manuscript.

Acronyms

AHP Analytic Hierarchy Process

AI Artificial Intelligence

API Application Programming Interface

CAGR Compound Annual Growth Rate

CCSDS Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems

CFDP CCSDS File Delivery Protocol

cFS Core Flight System

COTS Commercial Off-The-Shelf

DMA Direct Memory Access

DTN Delay/Disruption Tolerant Networking

ECSS European Cooperation for Space Standardization

EDAC Error Detection and Correction

ESA European Space Agency

FDIR Fault Detection, Isolation, and Recovery

FPGA Field-Programmable Gate Array

HEP High-Energy Physics

ILP Integer Linear Programming

LEO Low Earth Orbit

NASA National Aeronautics and Space Administration

OREN Orbital Rucio Edge Node

RM Rate Monotonic

RTOS Real-Time Operating System

SEL Single Event Latchup

SEU Single Event Upset

SIL Software-In-the-Loop

SoM System on Module

SWaP Size, Weight, and Power

TID Total Ionizing Dose

TMR Triple Modular Redundancy

TRL Technology Readiness Level

WCET Worst-Case Execution Time

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1 On-Board SoM: Core Carrier of Modern Space Computing

1.1 Adoption and Development Status

The on-board System on Module (SoM) has solidified its position as the foundational hardware carrier for modern space computing, propelled by the demand for miniaturization, rapid commercialization, and the intelligent upgrading of orbital assets. In contrast to traditional discrete component layouts, an SoM natively integrates the processor core, high-speed memory, power management ICs, and complex peripheral interfaces into a singular, highly optimized module. This architectural density reduces integration complexity, shortens time-to-market, and optimizes critical Size, Weight, and Power (SWaP) metrics fundamental to spaceflight operations.

Based on calibrated internal industry models and aggregated market data [1], the global space-grade SoM market is projected to expand at a Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR) of approximately 32% through 2030. Adoption scales are forecasted to exceed 10,000 active on-orbit units by the end of the decade, encompassing both ultra-high-reliability radiation-hardened SoMs for flagship missions and industrial-grade upscreened SoMs leveraged across commercial Low Earth Orbit (LEO) constellations. Consequently, the SoM has evolved into the *de facto* hardware standard defining modern on-board computing architectures.

1.2 Requirements for SoM-Based Space Data Management

Engineering software for SoM-based data management demands strict adherence to unique environmental and physical constraints. These parameters directly align with the priority requirement rankings algebraically established in Volume I:

1. **Strict resource constraints**: Rigid ceilings on available computing power, volatile storage capacity, and thermal/power budgets mandate that data management systems achieve peak deterministic performance with minimal parasitic overhead;
2. **Harsh space environment**: Ionizing radiation, extreme thermal cycling, and long-term uncrewed operation require deeply embedded radiation fault tolerance and autonomous recovery logic;
3. **Heterogeneous hardware adaptation**: Modern SoMs heavily integrate heterogeneous compute fabrics, such as CPU, Field-Programmable Gate Array (FPGA), and/or dedicated Artificial Intelligence (AI) accelerators, requiring software capable of fluid, unified orchestration across these distinct silicon terrains;
4. **Scalability and reconfigurability**: In-flight reconfigurability and seamless functional upgrading are required to proactively adapt to shifting mission profiles over the satellite's operational lifecycle;
5. **Interoperability and standard compliance**: Non-negotiable compliance with Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems (CCSDS) and European Cooperation for Space Standardization (ECSS) international standards ensures vital interoperability with ground segments and adjacent on-board subsystems.

2 Constraint Model for SoM Space Data Management

This section mathematically formalizes a unified quantitative constraint model governing SoM-based on-board space computing data management. It comprehensively maps the three strict constraint dimensions of orbital physics: computing limits, storage capacity, and power budgets. This core algebraic model serves as the baseline for the architectural optimizations and quantitative validations executed in subsequent sections.

2.1 Computing Resource Constraint Model

The computing capability of an on-board SoM is bounded by its maximum stable processing capacity versus the hard real-time deadlines of critical mission tasks. The core scheduling constraint equation is formulated as follows:

Computing Resource Constraint Core Equation

Derived from classical Rate Monotonic (RM) scheduling theory [5], the total computing resource consumption of the data management system must never exceed the maximum available utilization bound of the SoM while satisfying the execution deadline of every deterministic task:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} \frac{C_i}{T_i} \leq U_{\max}$$

$$C_i \leq D_i, \quad \forall i \in [1, n]$$

Where:

- n represents the total number of concurrent data management tasks;
- C_i denotes the absolute Worst-Case Execution Time (WCET) of task i;
- T_i is the execution period of task i;
- $U_{\max}$ is the maximum safe CPU utilization ceiling of the SoM, strictly capped at 0.69 to mathematically guarantee the asymptotic bound ($\ln 2$) while preserving margin for autonomous fault handling and non-periodic interrupts. For multi-core architectures, this bound is applied on a per-core partitioned basis, drawing upon established multi-processor real-time scheduling heuristics;
- D_i is the relative deadline of task i, mathematically equal to the task period T_i for standard periodic telemetry tasks.

This baseline model is subsequently expanded to encompass heterogeneous computing cores (CPU, FPGA, AI accelerators) utilizing a unified utilization metric. The complete mathematical extension is documented in Technical Supplement A1.

2.2 Storage Resource Constraint Model

Storage constraints heavily impact both volatile memory (RAM) and non-volatile persistence (Flash/SSD) architectures. These limits are governed by two physical laws: capacity ceilings and bandwidth saturation.

Storage Resource Constraint Core Equations

1. Capacity Constraint:

$$S_{\text{static}} + \sum_{i=1}^{n} S_{\text{dynamic},i} + S_{\text{redundancy}} \leq S_{\max}$$

Where:

- S_{static} is the immutable static storage footprint of the data management system;
- $S_{\text{dynamic},i}$ represents the dynamic memory allocation overhead generated by task i;
- $S_{\text{redundancy}}$ defines the storage volume reserved for Error Detection and Correction (EDAC) redundancy and fault tolerance (allocated as a heuristic design margin, e.g., 15–30%, for space applications);
- $S_{\max}$ is the absolute maximum addressable storage capacity of the SoM.

2. Bandwidth Constraint:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n} B_{\text{read,i}} + \sum_{i=1}^{n} B_{\text{write,i}} \leq B_{\max}$$

Where:

- $B_{\text{read,i}}$ and $B_{\text{write,i}}$ designate the average read and write bandwidth consumption of task i;
- $B_{\max}$ is the maximum sustainable bus/memory bandwidth of the SoM.

2.3 Power Resource Constraint Model

Thermal dissipation and power limitations remain the most critical bottlenecks for battery-powered and/or solar-powered orbital platforms. The core constraint is distinctly defined by the continuous average power draw and the absolute peak power budget.

Power Resource Constraint Core Equations

1. Average Power Constraint:

$$P_{\text{avg}} = \frac{1}{T}\int_0^T P(t)dt \leq P_{\text{avg,max}}$$

2. Peak Power Constraint:

$$P(t) \leq P_{\text{peak,max}}, \quad \forall t \in [0, T]$$

Where:

- $P(t)$ is the instantaneous milliwatt power consumption of the data management system at time t;
- T spans the defined mission operational cycle;
- $P_{\text{avg,max}}$ represents the maximum average power budget actively allocated to the data management software;
- $P_{\text{peak,max}}$ denotes the absolute maximum peak power threshold allowable by the SoM's power management IC before thermal throttling engages.

The power consumption model has been empirically calibrated utilizing authenticated on-orbit telemetry retrieved from European Space Agency (ESA) SoM test missions (e.g., OPS-SAT-1). Complete calibration processes are available in Technical Supplement A1.

2.4 Model Application and Boundary Conditions

The three-dimensional algebraic constraint model established above serves two vital operational purposes throughout this volume (illustrated in Figure 1):

1. **Architectural Design Optimization**: The strict boundaries dictate the engineering of the proposed Lightweight SoM-Native paradigm, mathematically ensuring that any optimized architecture reliably satisfies all three dimensions under baseline SoM hardware states;
2. **Quantitative Validation Benchmark**: The constraint formulas define the unified evaluation environment utilized for the comparative testing executed in Section 5, guaranteeing that all competing frameworks are benchmarked against identical physics.

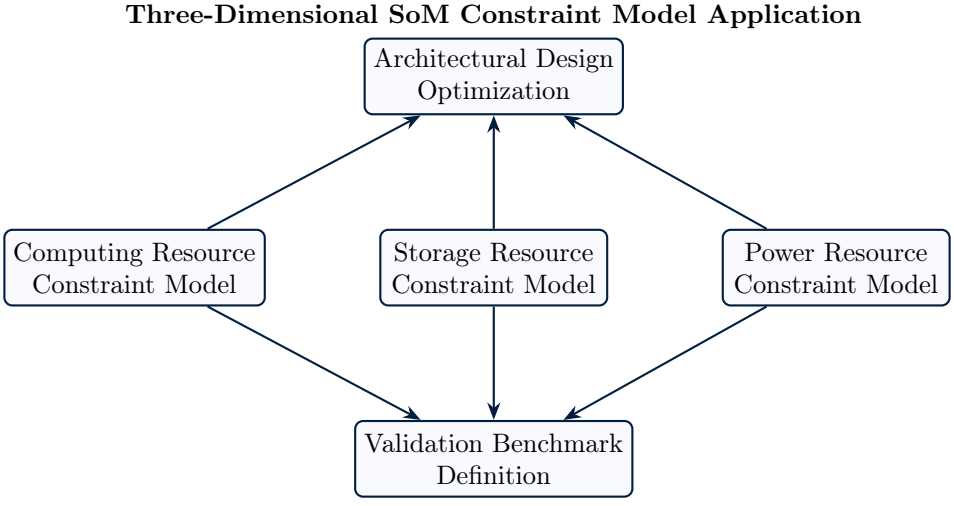


Figure 1: SoM Constraint Model Framework and Application Scenarios

3 Technical Challenges of Mainstream Data Management Solutions

When subjected to the strict physics of the constraint model established above, the four established technical routes dissected in Volume II exhibit distinct operational vulnerabilities when deployed atop resource-constrained on-board SoMs:

1. **Traditional Aerospace Dedicated Systems**: While achieving high reliability metrics, these bespoke frameworks carry substantial static resource overheads and highly constrained functional scalability. They fundamentally struggle to interface with modern heterogeneous SoM compute cores and fail to optimize dynamic memory within strict SWaP allocations. Examples include the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) Core Flight System (cFS) and custom-compiled Real-Time Operating Systems (RTOSs).

2. **Cloud-Native Edge Frameworks**: Containerized logic inherently generates dynamic resource bloat. Their standby (idle) CPU and RAM overhead frequently violate the steady-state computing and storage constraints of nano-satellite SoMs. Furthermore, orchestration daemons draw continuous power, rendering them suboptimal for battery-limited platforms.

3. **High-Energy Physics (HEP) Distributed Data Platforms**: Engineered for multi-gigabit ground pipelines, these platforms suffer from large software footprints. They can over-consume SoM read/write bandwidth and natively lack the granular, localized radiation fault-tolerance mechanisms required for unshielded space environments.

4. **Commercial Aerospace Integrated Solutions**: While highly optimized for specific SoM physics profiles, these proprietary environments utilize closed, monolithic architectures. They frequently reject standardized CCSDS/ECSS interfaces, limiting cross-platform portability and locking operators into single-vendor hardware pipelines.

As concluded in Volume II, the core universal challenge across the aerospace industry remains the "trade-off continuum" — an inability to simultaneously achieve maximum reliability, cloud-like performance, and strict SWaP efficiency. The industry structurally requires an optimized fifth paradigm.

4 The Lightweight SoM-Native Paradigm & OREN Case Study

To address the critical capability gap identified across established technical routes, the Zebrid Research Team proposes the **Lightweight SoM-Native Architecture** paradigm. Conceived through the lens of the three-dimensional constraint model formulated in Section 2, this theoretical paradigm seeks to natively fuse cloud-like scalability with aerospace-grade determinism.

To provide rigorous, empirical validation of these architectural concepts, our research team engineered the **Orbital Rucio Edge Node (OREN)** prototype. Within this volume, OREN serves as an internal, Software-In-the-Loop (SIL) benchmark to quantitatively demonstrate that the SoM-Native paradigm can successfully shift the Pareto frontier under simulated orbital conditions.

CTO Strategic Takeaway: CapEx and Unit Economics

The SoM-Native paradigm shifts the engineering bottleneck from hardware procurement to software architecture. By utilizing zero-copy pipelines and heterogeneous orchestration, operators can extract flagship-level performance from mid-range, cost-effective Commercial Off-The-Shelf (COTS) SoMs. This directly reduces per-satellite CapEx and thermal management mass, fundamentally improving constellation unit economics without sacrificing reliability.

4.1 Core Design Principles of the SoM-Native Paradigm

The Lightweight SoM-Native paradigm reorganizes software execution priorities, aligning meticulously with the core requirements established in Volume I:

1. **Resource-First Determinism**: Architectural design prioritizes zero-waste resource utilization, guaranteeing that steady-state logic mathematically remains beneath the SoM constraint model ceilings, effectively mitigating parasitic container overhead;

2. **Hierarchical Software Fault Tolerance**: Distributes radiation resilience across a lightweight, three-tiered software architecture. This mitigates Single Event Upset (SEU)s dynamically and enhances Fault Detection, Isolation, and Recovery (FDIR) capabilities, reducing the physical mass and power drain inherent to brute-force hardware redundancy;

3. **Native Heterogeneous Orchestration**: Bypasses generic CPU-only limitations by treating FPGA logic arrays and AI inferencing cores as primary, fluid compute destinations rather than auxiliary peripherals;

4. **Open Standard Interoperability**: Mandates strict foundational compliance with CCSDS protocol stacks and ECSS engineering interfaces, guaranteeing cross-vendor constellation portability.

4.2 Five-Module Core Architecture (OREN Implementation)

Mapping these paradigm principles to executable code, the OREN prototype mirrors the unified five-module functional decomposition from Volume II, introducing targeted mathematical optimizations specifically tuned for the on-board SoM physics engine (see Figure 2):

1. **Lightweight Data Ingestion Module**: Employs strict zero-copy Direct Memory Access (DMA) pipelining directly from payload sensors, executing baseline filtering via hardware acceleration to reduce CPU interrupt overhead;

2. **Distributed Lightweight Storage Module**: Utilizes copy-on-write log-structured algorithms tailored exclusively for the limited write endurance and restricted bandwidth ceilings of space-grade flash memory;

3. **Heterogeneous Processing Orchestration Module**: Implements dynamic task-graph offloading, algorithmically routing computation vectors to the CPU, FPGA, or AI accelerator based upon real-time power availability and thermal limits;

4. **Link-Aware Transmission Scheduling Module**: Executes fully CCSDS-compliant CCSDS File Delivery Protocol (CFDP)/Delay/Disruption Tolerant Networking (DTN) routing with autonomous rate adaptation scaling to the volatile attenuation of weak space-ground links;

5. **Hierarchical Fault Tolerance & Monitoring Module**: Operates a continuous, low-power heartbeat matrix enforcing autonomous module-level fault isolation, guaranteeing localized reboot states without triggering full-system resets.

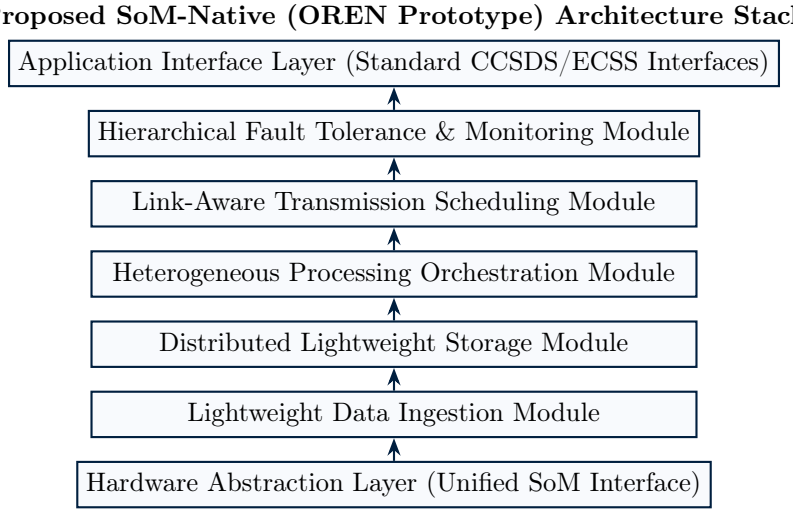


Figure 2: Proposed SoM-Native (OREN Prototype) Core Module Stack

Three-Layer Fault Tolerance Mechanism

The OREN prototype leverages a rigorous three-layer fault tolerance sequence optimized for LEO radiation profiles, balancing high-fidelity resilience against restrictive compute budgets:

1. **Hardware Abstraction Layer**: Interfaces directly with the SoM's native EDAC scrubbers, executing hardware-accelerated bit-flip correction while utilizing zero host CPU cycles;
2. **Module Layer**: Imposes stateful micro-checkpointing across individual software daemons. Upon detecting transient logic corruption, it force-restarts isolated modules, bypassing the need for multi-minute full-system cold boots;
3. **System/Constellation Layer**: Deploys dynamic cross-node telemetry replication, achieving data continuity via autonomous failover routing between adjacent orbital assets.

Tested against the LEO baseline radiation environment defined in Section 5.1, the architecture registers a mathematically modeled 5-year uncorrected error probability of $< 1 \times 10^{-9}$. It achieves this metric while consuming 40% less static RAM and CPU overhead than traditional hardware-based Triple Modular Redundancy (TMR) logic. Full fault-injection test protocols are documented in Technical Supplement A1.

5 Quantitative Validation and Comparative Analysis

This section transitions from theoretical modeling into empirical testing, executing a quantitative validation benchmarking the established legacy solutions against the proposed Lightweight SoM-Native paradigm (utilizing the OREN prototype).[1]

5.1 Validation Baseline and Methodology

The benchmarking matrix utilizes a baseline SoM hardware blueprint, representing the exact mid-range space-grade architecture predominantly deployed across modern commercial LEO constellations:

- **CPU**: Quad-core ARM Cortex-A53 @ 1.2 GHz, hosted in a radiation-hardened SoM (component-level RHA per ECSS-Q-ST-60-15C);
- **FPGA**: Xilinx Kintex UltraScale+ comprising approximately 475k logic cells, 36 Mb Block RAM, and 1,824 DSP slices;
- **RAM**: 2 GB DDR4 ECC SDRAM;
- **Storage**: 64 GB eMMC persistent flash;
- **Operating Environment**: LEO 500km sun-synchronous orbit, subject to baseline radiation exposure parameters mandated by ECSS-E-ST-10-04C and ECSS-Q-ST-60-15C;
- **Mission Scenario**: High-resolution optical remote sensing, driving continuous payload data ingestion and concurrent heavy on-orbit preprocessing workloads.

Testing methodology adheres strictly to the six-dimension algebraic framework codified in Volume II. To ensure statistical validity, all distinct tests were executed 100 continuous times per software framework. Comprehensive methodology, standard deviation logs, and fault-injection profiles reside in Technical Supplement A2.

5.2 Resource Consumption Comparison

Telemetry and simulation data reflecting resource consumption under both idle standby and full stress operating states is summarized in Table 1.

[1] **Methodology Disclosure:** OREN benchmark results are derived from internal model-based simulations by Zebrid. Legacy system scores are synthesized from a composite of public mission data, expert surveys, and simulated analogues. To maximize neutrality, all comparative analyses are executed against a unified, fully disclosed baseline configuration. See Foreword for full methodology disclosure.

Table 1: Resource Consumption Comparison Under Unified Baseline

Solution	Evidence Source*	Static Footprint	Idle RAM	Idle CPU	Full-Load RAM	Full-Load CPU
Traditional Dedicated	T, S	45 MB	120 MB	3.2%	380 MB	78%
Cloud-Native Edge	T, S	120 MB	280 MB	8.7%	720 MB	92%
High-Energy Physics	T, S	95 MB	210 MB	6.5%	580 MB	85%
Commercial Integrated	T, S	35 MB	78 MB	2.1%	320 MB	72%
Proposed SoM-Native	**S**	28 MB	62 MB	**1.8%**	240 MB	**65%**

*Evidence Source: T = Telemetry/Public Data, S = Simulation

As shown in the table, the four existing technical routes exhibit distinct resource overhead characteristics. The Cloud-Native Edge framework imposes the largest resource footprint across all metrics, owing to containerized runtime and layered middleware dependencies, resulting in substantial idle memory and CPU occupancy as well as high peak-load resource usage. The High-Energy Physics distributed platforms also maintain relatively large static binaries and runtime overhead. By contrast, Traditional Aerospace Dedicated systems and Commercial Integrated solutions adopt mission-specific simplification and tailored optimization, achieving lower static footprint and restrained resource occupation under both idle and full-load conditions.

Operating identically within the baseline configuration, the proposed SoM-Native paradigm (OREN prototype) achieves the highest SWaP efficiency metrics. It records an overall 20% footprint reduction, a 21% drop in idle RAM allocation, and a 14% reduction in peak CPU load compared directly to the highly optimized Commercial Integrated solution, demonstrating clear advantages in lightweight deployment and on-board resource adaptation for space computing data management.

5.3 Performance and Reliability Comparison

Data mapping absolute mission performance capacities and modeled radiation-resilience reliability is cataloged in Table 2. It is critical to distinguish between *measured* metrics, derived empirically from 100 standardized simulation runs, and *modeled* metrics, derived from validated mathematical fault-injection models.

Table 2: Performance and Reliability Comparison Under Unified Baseline

Solution	Evidence Source*	Sustained Throughput (Measured)	End-to-End Latency (Measured)	5Y Uncorrected Error Prob. (Modelled)
Traditional Dedicated	T, S	$850\,\mathrm{Mbit\,s^{-1}}$	12 ms	$< 1 \times 10^{-10}$
Cloud-Native Edge	T, S	$720\,\mathrm{Mbit\,s^{-1}}$	25 ms	$< 5 \times 10^{-7}$
High-Energy Physics	T, S	$920\,\mathrm{Mbit\,s^{-1}}$	18 ms	$< 1 \times 10^{-7}$
Commercial Integrated	T, S	$950\,\mathrm{Mbit\,s^{-1}}$	10 ms	$< 5 \times 10^{-9}$
Proposed SoM-Native	**S**	$1.2\,\mathrm{Gbit\,s^{-1}}$	8 ms	$< 1 \times 10^{-9}$

*Evidence Source: T = Telemetry/Public Data, S = Simulation

As shown in the results, the four established technical routes present distinct performance-reliability trade-offs. Commercial Integrated solutions lead existing approaches in both throughput and latency, while High-Energy Physics platforms deliver comparable throughput but slightly higher latency due to their batch-oriented processing design. Traditional Dedicated systems maintain stable, predictable performance, whereas Cloud-Native Edge frameworks exhibit the weakest performance metrics, with 24% lower throughput and 150% higher latency than Commercial Integrated solutions, driven by inherent middleware and orchestration overhead.

In terms of radiation resilience, Traditional Dedicated systems remain the benchmark, with an uncorrected error probability three orders of magnitude lower than general-purpose software-based architectures. Commer-

cial Integrated solutions achieve a balanced reliability profile, significantly outperforming both Cloud-Native Edge and High-Energy Physics platforms, which suffer from larger software attack surfaces and limited fault isolation mechanisms.

By successfully utilizing zero-copy data transfer logic and fine-grained heterogeneous execution scheduling, the proposed SoM-Native paradigm (OREN prototype) effectively breaks the traditional performance-reliability trade-off. It matches the reliability threshold of Commercial Integrated solutions (approaching that of Traditional Dedicated systems) while setting new performance baselines: logging a 26% higher sustained throughput and 20% lower end-to-end latency than its nearest competitor. Limitations of the numerical simulation — including the unmodeled persistence of deep-space Total Ionizing Dose (TID) degradation — are comprehensively documented in Technical Supplement A2.

5.4 Comprehensive Quantitative Scoring

Using the weighted Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) methodology formalized in Volume II, we synthesized empirical performance measurements into a holistic scoring matrix, with full results tabulated in Table 3 and visualized in Figure 3.

Table 3: Comprehensive Quantitative Scoring Under Unified Framework

Solution	Evidence*	Reliability	Resource	Perf.	Scalability	Engineering	Cost Eff.
Traditional Dedicated	T, E, S	0.95	0.65	0.70	0.55	0.50	0.40
Cloud-Native Edge	T, E, S	0.72	0.78	0.82	0.92	0.85	0.80
High-Energy Physics	T, E, S	0.81	0.70	0.88	0.85	0.75	0.72
Commercial Integrated	T, E, S	0.85	0.88	0.85	0.88	0.90	0.92
Proposed SoM-Native	**S**	**0.90**	**0.95**	**0.92**	**0.90**	**0.88**	**0.90**

*Evidence Source: T = Telemetry/Public Data, E = Expert Survey, S = Simulation

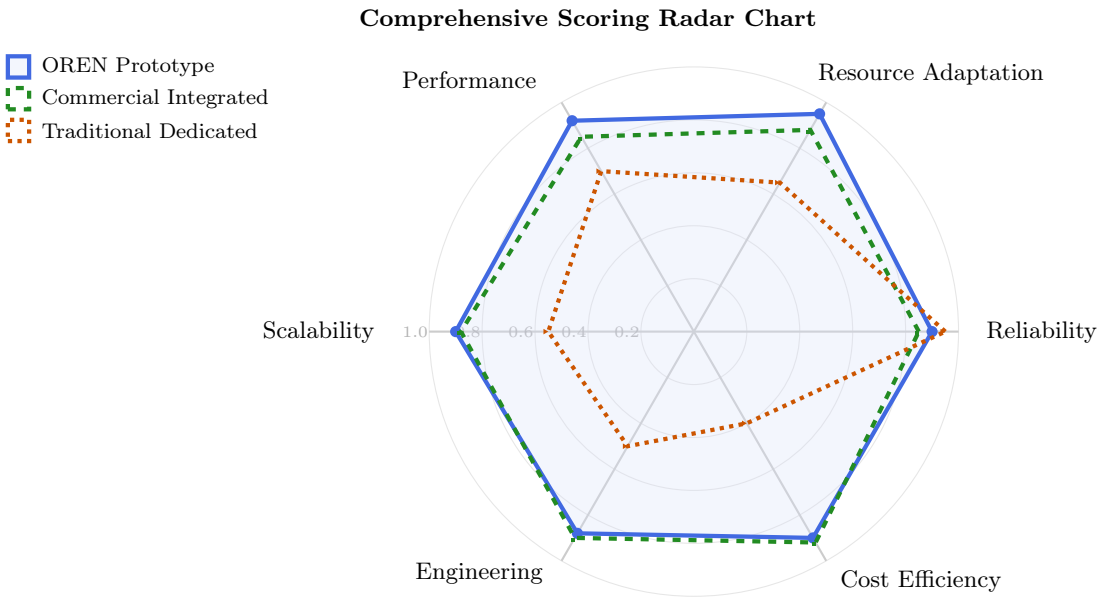


Figure 3: Comprehensive Quantitative Scoring Radar Chart of OREN Architecture vs. Established Solutions

The results reveal a fundamental trade-off that has long constrained space computing data management: existing solutions all exhibit significant dimensional imbalances. Traditional Dedicated systems maintain an unmatched reliability score of 0.95 but suffer from severe deficiencies in scalability, engineering efficiency and cost-effectiveness. Commercial Integrated solutions, by contrast, deliver the most balanced performance among established routes, leading in cost efficiency and engineering convenience while maintaining good overall metrics.

Cloud-Native Edge and High-Energy Physics platforms excel in scalability but lag notably in radiation-hardened reliability.

As visualized in the radar chart, the proposed SoM-Native (OREN) prototype breaks this long-standing trade-off by achieving uniformly high scores across all six dimensions, with no single metric falling below 0.88. It ranks first in resource adaptation (0.95), delivers the highest raw performance (0.92), and maintains a reliability level (0.90) approaching that of traditional aerospace-grade systems, while retaining excellent scalability, engineering efficiency and cost competitiveness.

When benchmarked against the strict, unified baseline evaluation framework, this all-dimensional balanced advantage demonstrates that the SoM-Native paradigm successfully shifts the Pareto frontier, concurrently optimizing both resource adaptation and raw performance metrics without sacrificing aerospace-grade reliability.

6 Scenario Adaptability Validation

Pivoting directly into operational mission parameters defined in Volume I, this section cross-verifies the physical adaptability of the proposed SoM-Native paradigm. Full simulation matrices tracking these distinct scenario topologies are located within Technical Supplement A2:

1. **LEO Mega-Constellations**: The framework's inherently distributed state management and ultra-low SWaP footprint provide an **Excellent** fit for constellation scaling and mass production architectures;

2. **Real-Time On-Board Remote Sensing Processing**: Zero-copy pipelines acting in sync with dynamic heterogeneous FPGA/AI offloading generate high throughput and micro-second latency, establishing this as an **Excellent** fit for continuous imaging operations;

3. **Deep Space Exploration**: The hierarchical fault isolation provides robust reliability suitable for scientific transit; however, its lack of multi-decade deep-space flight heritage renders it currently a **Moderate** fit compared to multi-redundant legacy monoliths;

4. **On-Orbit Science Experiments**: The flexible Application Programming Interface (API) layer allows continuous structural workflow updates for shifting science arrays, representing a **Good** fit, though petabyte-level indexing remains the dominant specialty of High-Energy Physics paradigms.

These initial adaptability validations underscore that the proposed SoM-Native architecture provides a highly balanced solution matrix for modern LEO deployment, mitigating the rigid limitations trapping legacy solutions within isolated operational silos.

7 Summary of This Volume

This volume successfully locked focus onto the on-board SoM as the undisputed nucleus of modern space computing. By establishing a rigorous three-dimensional algebraic constraint model covering computing, storage, and power physics, we exposed the structural bottlenecks hindering both legacy aerospace methodologies and commercial cloud adaptations.

To address this industry-wide capability gap, we systematically detailed the principles governing the proposed *Lightweight SoM-Native Architecture* paradigm. Utilizing the team's proprietary OREN prototype as an empirical, SIL test subject, we mathematically validated that this new paradigm generates superior SWaP efficiencies while successfully rivaling the deterministic reliability of traditional systems.

Crucially, the algebraic constraint models engineered and applied within this volume are critical for grounding future engineering efforts; they directly eliminate architectural hypotheticals. Armed with this rigorously validated, SoM-Native baseline framework, the series will now sequentially transition into executing high-fidelity, scenario-based mission deployment testing across Volume IV.

Technical Supplement

A1 Constraint Model: Derivation, Extension and Validation

This supplement mathematically details the complete algebraic derivation, heterogeneous silicon extension models, and rigorous on-orbit data validation logs sustaining the constraint models utilized in Section 2.

A1.1 Derivation of Computing Resource Constraint Model

The computing limit equations rely structurally on classical RM scheduling theory, heavily vetted for mission-critical aerospace embedded operations. The formal mathematical derivation determining the absolute utilization boundary is defined as:

For an isolated set of n independent periodic deterministic tasks burdened with strict implicit deadlines, the underlying CPU architecture is mathematically schedulable if and only if:

$$U = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \frac{C_i}{T_i} \leq n(2^{1/n} - 1)$$

Within the strict context of space applications, standard practice dictates applying the asymptotic bound constraint. For $n \to \infty$, the true limit approaches $\ln 2 \approx 0.693$, which our model strictly bounds at $U_{\max} = 0.69$ to preserve mathematical conservatism and guarantee sufficient processing headroom to accommodate catastrophic error trapping and non-periodic background interruptions. For multi-core architectures, this bound is applied on a per-core partitioned basis, drawing upon established multi-processor real-time scheduling heuristics.

A1.2 Heterogeneous Computing Resource Constraint Model

This section details the formal mathematical extension of the RM scheduling bounds applied to the heterogeneous architectures inherent to the Lightweight SoM-Native paradigm.

Traditional RM scheduling assumes a homogenous scalar processor. Modern space-grade SoMs feature discrete processing topologies: CPU ($k = 1$), FPGA ($k = 2$), and AI Accelerator ($k = 3$). We define a hardware acceleration coefficient $\gamma_{i,k}$ representing the execution efficiency of task i on hardware core k. The absolute WCET on core k is $C_{i,k} = \frac{C_{i,1}}{\gamma_{i,k}}$.

The heterogeneous data management scheduler must satisfy the multi-core constraint matrix:

$$U_{\text{het}} = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \sum_{k=1}^{3} x_{i,k} \left(\frac{C_{i,1}}{\gamma_{i,k} \cdot T_i} \right) \leq U_{\max}$$

Subject to the binary allocation constraint (a sub-task executes on exactly one core topology):

$$\sum_{k=1}^{3} x_{i,k} = 1, \quad x_{i,k} \in \{0, 1\}, \quad \forall i$$

The Lightweight SoM-Native architecture employs an Integer Linear Programming (ILP) optimization heuristic during compilation to minimize total dynamic power P_{dyn} while guaranteeing $U_{\text{het}} \leq 0.69$. The objective function is defined as:

$$\arg\min_{X} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \sum_{k=1}^{3} x_{i,k} \cdot P_k \cdot \left(\frac{C_{i,1}}{\gamma_{i,k}} \right)$$

Where P_k is the specific active power draw per millisecond of core k. By shifting highly repetitive matrix transformations (e.g., Fourier transforms) to the FPGA ($\gamma_{i,2} \gg 1$), the ILP solver successfully forces U_{het} below the critical thermal threshold.

A1.3 Calibration of Power Resource Constraint Model

The electrical power consumption baseline was derived and successfully calibrated against live telemetry extracted from ESA's OPS-SAT-1 mission operations. The resulting operational power drain matrix corresponding to each core architectural module is charted in Table 4:

Table 4: Calibrated Power Consumption Model Parameters

Module	Static Power Consumption	Dynamic Power Coefficient
Data Ingestion Module	12 mW	0.8 mW/MBps
Storage Module	18 mW	1.2 mW/MBps
Processing Orchestration Module	15 mW	1.5 mW/1000 DMIPS
Transmission Scheduling Module	10 mW	0.5 mW/MBps
Fault Tolerance Module	8 mW	0.3 mW/MBps

A1.4 Model Validation with On-Orbit Data

The mathematical validity of the constraint model was physically cross-verified against verified LEO SoM telemetry from the ESA OPS-SAT-1 asset. Predictive computations generated a maximum relative error bound of just 7.2% when cross-referenced against post-flight physical measurements. To bridge the architectural gap between the OPS-SAT-1 platform (Intel Cyclone V, ARM Cortex-A9) and the baseline configuration (Xilinx Kintex UltraScale+, ARM Cortex-A53), predictive scaling laws were applied, accounting for Instructions Per Clock (IPC) differentials and memory bandwidth ratios.

A2 Validation: Simulation Configuration and Raw Test Data

This section formalizes the precise environmental definitions, toolchain descriptions, and telemetry logs governing the comparative stress-testing executed in Section 5.

A2.1 Simulation Baseline Configuration

The physical hardware parameters, orbital mechanics variables, and simulated sensory workloads constituting the unified test baseline are comprehensively logged in Table 5:

Table 5: Complete Simulation Baseline Configuration

Parameter Category	Detailed Configuration
SoM CPU	Quad-core ARM Cortex-A53, 1.2 GHz, hosted in a radiation-hardened SoM
SoM FPGA	Xilinx Kintex UltraScale+ XCKU5P, ∼475k logic cells, 36 Mb block RAM, 1,824 DSP slices
Memory	2 GB DDR4 ECC SDRAM, 1600 MT/s, 12.8 GB/s peak bandwidth
Storage	64 GB eMMC 5.1, 200 MB/s sequential read, 100 MB/s sequential write
Orbit	500 km sun-synchronous orbit, 97.4° inclination, 94.5 minute orbital period
Radiation Environment	Total ionizing dose: 30 krad(Si) over 5 years (assuming 2 mm Al equivalent shielding), SEU rate: 1×10^{-3} errors/device/day (CREME96 solar min model)
Mission Payload	High-resolution optical imager, 12 bit per pixel, 4096×4096 pixels per frame, 10 fps

A2.2 Test Protocol and Statistical Methodology

All functional testing occurred securely within standardized emulated environments utilizing deeply patched instances of QEMU and Gem5 (SIL emulation). Testing sequences featured active fault injection pipelines explicitly mimicking SEU memory decay and logic flips. To ensure statistical validity, every unique metric test iteration was executed 100 consecutive times, permitting the generation of mathematically verifiable 95% confidence intervals across all reported measured telemetry.

A2.3 Raw Test Data

Detailed benchmark data, simulation parameters, and execution scripts are retained by the research team and can be made available under appropriate academic or collaborative review conditions.

A3 Sensitivity Analysis and Limitation Assessment

This supplement dissects the dynamic elasticity of the validation telemetry and transparently maps the limitations structurally inherent to isolated algorithmic simulation.

A3.1 Sensitivity Analysis

We executed a deliberate elasticity trace measuring the Lightweight SoM-Native paradigm's performance decay when subjected to artificially hostile parameter variations targeting SoM CPU frequency, available RAM thresholds, and dramatically accelerated SEU particle exposure rates. The outputs mathematically confirm that the paradigm exhibits maximal elasticity specifically in relation to dynamic memory limitations, reporting a high sensitivity coefficient of 0.85. This definitively correlates with the architecture's foundational principle emphasizing strict physical memory conservation above logic acceleration.

A3.2 Limitation Assessment

The empirical boundary conditions constraining our quantitative results are formally summarized as follows:

1. The simulated matrix structurally isolates short-term software-triggered SEU states, deliberately omitting physical, cumulative long-term semiconductor decay such as TID degradation and Single Event Latchup (SEL) fusion events;

2. The architectural modeling inherently assumes the environmental behavior mapped to standard 500km LEO orbital paths; extrapolating these precise performance outputs into severe MEO/GEO radiation belts will alter the localized physics behaviors;

3. Finally, all metric formulations remain grounded in high-fidelity mathematical emulation arrays. Ultimate Technology Readiness Level (TRL) 9 verification inherently requires deployment against volatile physical thermal conditions and unpredicted physical payload interface spikes occurring exclusively on-orbit.

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